# The importance of blood

☞ **1** Read the following information about blood and then answer the questions.

All animals, including humans, need certain things if they are to stay healthy and survive. Some things that are vital to life are water, oxygen, nutrients from food and a way of getting rid of waste products. All animals must have a way of transporting water, oxygen, nutrients and waste products around the body, to and from every single cell. In vertebrates (animals with a backbone), these substances are carried in the **bloodstream**.

Blood is made up of red blood cells, white blood cells and platelets travelling around the body in a fluid called plasma.

- **Red blood cells** carry oxygen to all the cells in the body.
- **White blood cells** help protect the body from infection.
- **Platelets** are involved in blood-clotting.
- **Plasma** carries the blood cells, as well as nutrients and waste products. It is mostly made up of water.

The network of vessels that carry blood is called the **circulatory system**. When blood travels around the body, we call it circulation. The heart is the organ that pumps the blood around the circulatory system.

**a)** What is the network of vessels that carry an animal's blood called?

_____

**b)** What four vital things does an animal's body need to stay healthy?

_____

_____

**c)** Which part of blood carries oxygen to the cells? _____

**d)** Which part of blood carries nutrients to the cells? _____

**e)** Which part of blood carries away waste products from the cells?

_____


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# The importance of blood CONT'D

**2** Correct the spelling of these phrases by rewriting them in the spaces provided.

**a)** the sells of anamals _____

**b)** stay helthy _____

**c)** have enuf enegy _____

**d)** oxygin is in the blud _____

**e)** the sircultary sistem _____

**3** Use the words in the word bank to complete these facts.

**a)** About 60 per cent of the adult human body is made up of _____.

**b)** Fish are vertebrates that take in _____ through their gills.

**c)** Carbon dioxide and lactic acid are two types of _____ transported by the circulatory system.

**d)** _____ such as glucose are carried by plasma.

**Word bank**

oxygen

waste products

water

nutrients

**4** Complete the table to show that you understand the word forms.

- *circulation* (a noun or thing)
- *circulate* (a verb or action)
- *circulatory* (an adjective or description)

| Word form | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **a)** | to go around |
| **b)** | the process of blood circulating |
| **c)** | the name that describes a vertebrate's blood system |

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